Year 3 English | A Surprise at the Park

Learn and notice | Show a feeling through actions

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention

I can use actions and relevant details to help a reader infer a character's feelings.

The Surprise at the Oval

Mia stopped at the oval gate. Her friends stood around a large cardboard box, but nobody would tell her what was inside. She gripped the gate and took one small step forward.

The lid lifted to reveal a tiny remote-controlled car. Her friend set it on the grass, and it zipped across and stopped at her feet. Mia's shoulders relaxed. She crouched beside the car and reached eagerly for the controller.

Her friends showed her how to steer. Soon Mia was guiding the car around their cones. She waved them over for another race.

Writing detective

1. Which action suggests Mia is unsure at first?
2. Which action suggests her feelings change?
3. What event causes the change?

Notice and explain

A. Mia was nervous.
B. Mia gripped the gate and took one small step forward.
Which sentence shows a feeling through action? Explain your choice.

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Think and plan | Show a feeling through actions

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Your writing task

Write your own story set at a park. Include a beginning, a surprise, a reaction and a connected ending. Group related events in simple paragraphs.

Beginning

Who visits the park? What are they doing?

Surprise

What unexpected event happens? Keep it suitable for a school audience.

First reaction

What might the character do before they understand the surprise?

Changed reaction

What happens next? Show the new feeling through an action.

Ending

What does the character finally do? Connect it to the surprise.

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Write your draft | Use your own ideas

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Your turn

Write your own story set at a park. Include a beginning, a surprise, a reaction and a connected ending. Group related events in simple paragraphs.
Useful words: paused, gripped, relaxed, crouched, eagerly. Use words only when they fit.

My writing

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Edit and improve | Show what changed

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Read your draft aloud

[ ] The surprise connects to my beginning.
[ ] I used actions that fit the character's feelings.
[ ] The reader can tell why the feelings change.
[ ] My ending follows the events.

One focused improvement

Before: Noah was excited.
After: Noah bounced on his toes and hurried towards the picnic rug.
Choose a sentence that names a feeling. Replace or support it with an action that fits the event.

My before-and-after revision

Original sentence(s):

Improved version:

Explain your change

My change helps the reader because _____

Final writing detective check

[ ] I checked capitals, punctuation and spelling.
[ ] I grouped related ideas in paragraphs where useful.
[ ] I can explain one meaningful change.

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Teacher and parent guide | Answers and teaching support

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Teaching sequence

Use two sessions: read/discuss/plan (about 20–25 minutes), then write/revise (about 20–30 minutes). Adjust to the learner. Rehearse orally before writing; supply extra paper if needed. Models are teaching examples, not scripts to memorise.

Answers and acceptable alternatives

Accept gripping the gate or taking a small step as clues of uncertainty. Relaxing her shoulders and reaching eagerly suggest relief or enthusiasm. Seeing the remote-controlled car causes the change. Other supported inferences are valid.
Notice task: B shows actions from which a reader can infer a feeling; A names the feeling directly. Telling is not always wrong, but this task practises showing.

Support, challenge and coaching

Support: Act out a reaction and describe it orally. Offer an action bank: paused, stepped back, smiled, reached, waved.
Challenge: Show two different feelings without naming either. Explain the story evidence for each.
Ask: What could a reader infer from that action? Could it show a different feeling?

Record learning and check transfer

For each page 4 skill, record Not yet / With support / Independently. Give one specific next step and let the child make the change. Record adult prompting or scribing.
Later prompt: A Surprise at the School Gate. Hide the model and check whether the target skill transfers.
These are classroom practice criteria, not NAPLAN scores.

Curriculum and preparation scope

Supports selected aspects of AC9E3LY06: planning, creating and editing writing, simple paragraphs and language control.
Guided skill practice for NAPLAN preparation; not an official test or score prediction.
Sources: ACARA v9 Year 3 “Narrative - Oceania”; nap.edu.au narrative and persuasive writing guides.

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